The Swan Lake (A She-Ra 2018 AU)

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The Swan Lake (A She-Ra 2018 AU)

by Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

The Kingdom of Bright Moon has banned magic fourteen years ago, despite Princess Glimmer and Prince Adora having shown signs of magical potential from an early age. Now they turn twenty and remain untrained, oblivious of their true power. The ban on magic was declared the day the Royal Mage was to be chosen between their historical tutor, Light Spinner, and the King's sister, Castaspella, who got elected. It was known that Light Spinner could not handle defeat or frustration, yet no one could have guessed she'd curse her and swear to take revenge on the regents. Queen Angella immediately banned magic, forwent her own magic to keep her daughters safe, and all sorcerers had to abandon Bright Moon or swear never to use their magic again, like King Micah did. Since then, Light Spinner, now Shadow Weaver, has cursed several people, motivated by mere "aggravation", while Castaspella remained in the Whispering Woods, attentive to her every move, doing her best to counter the curses. Some could be lifted, yet she could only partially reverse the curse on those suffering her same fate. Neither Princess Glimmer nor Prince Adora should know the true story; Queen Angella has decided magic is now a threat, and so it must remain.

Notes

I had to edit the summary cause it was too long and I fr hate the final version, so here's the full version:

> The Kingdom of Bright Moon has always been known for its ruling Royal Family, all of them magical users of great power. Their Queen, an immortal being who's overseen the kingdom since immemorial times, has always inspired respect from other kingdoms, even those far away, as one of the most powerful individuals to have ever existed. However, for the last fourteen years, magic has been banned, even when Princess Glimmer and Prince Adora have also shown signs of magical potential from an early age. Now, they are about to turn twenty-one, and remain untrained, almost oblivious, of their true power.
> The events that led to this ban on magic, took place the day the Royal Mage was to be chosen. The candidates competing for the title were the Royal Family's historical tutor, Light Spinner, and the King's sister, Castaspella. And so, the moment Castaspella was chosen as Royal Mage, was the beginning of the end.
> It was known that Light Spinner could not handle defeat or frustration, yet no one could have guessed she'd curse Castaspella right there and then, turning her into a fox, while swearing to take revenge on the regents too for what they had done. Without hesitation, Queen Angella immediately banned magic, fearing what her revenge could be, and

preferring to forfeit her own magic if it meant her daughters would be safe. Since then, any and all sorcerers had to abandon Bright Moon or swear never to use their magic again, like King Micah did.

For the past decade and a half, the sorceress formerly known as Light Spinner, now called Shadow Weaver, has been cursing several people around the kingdom, motivated by nothing other than "offense" or "aggravation"; however, Castaspella has remained in the Whispering Woods since her transformation, always attentive to her every move, and making her best efforts to counter her curses. While some of them could be lifted, those turned into animals too had to join her in the woods, for she could only partially reverse the curse, allowing them to recover their original forms at nighttime and giving them a chance to visit the citadel for some hours.

For the safety of the kingdom, none of this should ever be known by either Princess Glimmer or Prince Adora, for they may want to undo the ban; Queen Angella has decided magic is a threat to the kingdom. And so it must remain.

And fyi here's the inspo notes for this work: a mix of Disney's "The Swan Princess", Tchaikovsky's ballet plot, and some additions that were made to that one Barbie version of the story. I don't follow any of them exactly down to the T, I just take little bits from all of them. For instance: Rothbarth!SW being aggravated by the king and that being the reason why Odette!Catra is cursed, happens in Disney's version, I took it as inspiration and only tangentially it happens to be the same reason; from here also the fact that Odette was a princess from another kingdom, their parents had tried to make her and Sigfried fall in love, but it didn't work, and they only do fall in love later on. The celebration being the princess (and prince's here) b-day happens in Tchaikovsky's ballet (and I can't recall if that was also the case with Barbie's version), same with going to hunt, but in this case Odette!Catra isn't a swan yet; there's also another reference to his ballet, related to how the curse couldn't be lifted if Rothbarth was killed (but I won't say more as to not spoil), as well as a reference to how Rothbarth revealed the illusion thing right in front of everyone. From the Barbie versions, rather than what remains identical to the ballet, I take details like the magical help that Fairy Queen provides and how she knew Rothbarth (except that here the relationship is different, but the point remains), how there were plenty of other cursed people and that they all could only recover their human forms at night thanks to that help. Ah right, and the happy ending follows both the Disney and the Barbie versions. Funny enough, many of the cursed characters were also chipped ones in the series (that was purely accidental), and you could consider there's technically a reference to *Save the Cat*. It sounds like a spoiler but, if you know The Swan Lake, you already know what happens. The original myth of the Swan Maiden in which the Swan Lake is inspired, a creature similar to an Hulder, a swan maiden, would be what inspired the "curse", but the rest of the story is heavily different and quite disgusting in terms of the general plot, so the only tributary reference to it is how Adora first sees Catra among the swans in her original form as she hasn't been cursed yet (which is also the only reference Tchaikovsky's version makes, but there the prince sees her turn into a human)

Now, I invite you to sit, relax, and enjoy the play…

Chapter 1

Chapter Summary

Characters:
ADORA, Prince of Bright Moon
GLIMMER, Princess of Bright Moon
KING MICAH, King of Bright Moon
QUEEN ANGELLA, Queen of Bright Moon

Prologue

SCENE.—*Land of Etheria. Inside Bright Moon's castle, late afternoon. A lounge area with sofas and cushions, small tables, and a few servants. Large colored windows at the back, a huge chandelier hanging from the ceiling, and a bookshelf on the left wall. ADORA and GLIMMER stand in the center, in front of QUEEN ANGELLA and KING MICAH.*

QUEEN ANGELLA. It is your twentieth birthday! Of course you will have the greatest ball ever seen in Bright Moon!

GLIMMER. Mom, it's fine. We don't need a Grand Ball…

QUEEN ANGELLA. Nonsense. It's a special occasion and shall be celebrated as is proper.

KING MICAH. Exactly. You are our precious daughters, future regents of Bright Moon. It is only natural for you two to start having this kind of major events, to introduce you to the royal society!

ADORA. But what if I'm not interested in the royal society?

QUEEN ANGELLA. [With a hand on ADORA's shoulder] With time you will understand, Dear. This is your world, and it is important that you learn the ropes, understand how our kingdom works, who is who, and meet your future subjects.

ADORA. [sighs] I understand.

QUEEN ANGELLA. Good. [Takes KING MICAH and walks a few steps away]

GLIMMER. [approaches ADORA] Hey, don't be so gloomy… I know you don't feel like celebrating, but mom is right! It's our introduction to society! And we get to dress pretty, eat all we want, and dance!

ADORA. Well, I don't want to dance!

GLIMMER. What has you in such a bad mood, Adora?

ADORA. Nothing. I'm just… annoyed.

GLIMMER. [Thoughtful] How about going for a ride with Spirit? Or you could go hunting!

ADORA. [Looks away, hiding a smile] Yes, it could be… But I'll go alone.

GLIMMER. Then don't lose time! Go, go! Shoo!

[ADORA exits.

QUEEN ANGELLA and KING MICAH stand at the back while GLIMMER daydreams about the ball]

KING MICAH. [To QUEEN ANGELLA] Don't you think we should tell them? They are already adults.

QUEEN ANGELLA. We can't. It's better if they never know.

KING MICAH. They will find out sooner or later.

QUEEN ANGELLA. I refuse. Magic has become a threat, it is not safe for them. It is better if they remain oblivious to both, their magic and ours.

KING MICAH. [Pleading] But…

QUEEN ANGELLA. [Interrupting] And who would teach them magic? Your cursed sister? We can't, Micah. We won't.

[KING MICAH looks down, silent. QUEEN ANGELLA turns and exits, followed by KING MICAH]

[Blackout]

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

Characters:
ADORA, Prince of Bright Moon
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act I

Scene 1

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, sundown. A lake to the left, dozens of swans wandering about are suddenly startled and fly away; a girl with cat ears and a tail runs behind them. At the back, dense trees and a shadow lurking. ADORA and her horse stand to the right between the trees next to some boulders, silently observing, mesmerized. The girl stops, notices ADORA, and approaches.*

ADORA. I am impressed with how agile and fast you are. [Bows courteously] Able to chase after them until they fly over the trees.

CATRA. Hey, prince Adora. [Smirks and bows back] Fancy finding you here… in your hunting grounds. [Laughs]

ADORA. Is that how *you* hunt?

CATRA. Of course not. That's how I *train*.

[CATRA and ADORA laugh. Both approach the boulders and sit down, looking away from each other shyly]

ADORA. It's been years since we last saw each other… How are things in Half Moon?

CATRA. One of my moms has been sick all these years and… I wouldn't dare leave them alone. [Looks down with a small smile] But now she's finally showing signs of recovery, and I wanted to visit Bright Moon again, so I took the chance… to see you. [Looks back at ADORA] How have you all been?

ADORA. It's been quite boring. Tutoring has been brutal. They don't give Glimmer a break, and I don't think I'm good enough yet at… anything.

CATRA. [Laughs] Please. We were eight and you thought you weren't eating correctly. You should chill a bit!

ADORA. Well, I did… "chill" a lot whenever you came to visit us for a week. It was so much fun!

CATRA. Yeah, I miss that too. But with the ban on magic here, my moms weren't really fond of coming usually, it was only to keep diplomatic relationships. So when that weird illness got to mom, they just had the perfect excuse not to come, I guess…

[Both look down silently for a moment]

ADORA. Catra, can I tell you something?

CATRA. Sure.

ADORA. I don't know how long you're staying, or if you'll be coming back soon, so I better say it now. [Takes a deep breath] Last time you were here, remember? We were fifteen, hunting together… And I was about to say something before my parents arrived.

CATRA. Yeah. You never said it.

ADORA. Well, I'd rather say it now before anything else happens. [Takes CATRA's hands and breathes in. A pause, then sighs] I like you. I really do. I would like you to be my partner and… come with me to the Grand Ball in two days? [Stammers] It's okay if you don't want…

CATRA. [Holds her hands tightly and smiles, pulling her closer] You're such an idiot. Of course I want to! [Laughs] And I suppose I was… a tiny bit in love too, back then. I would have said "yes".

[ADORA and CATRA kiss and hug]

ADORA. I'm so happy! I'll take you to the castle right now. We can tell mom and dad, I'm sure they'll be glad to have you in the family!

[The shadow at the back moves forward and enters the scene, surprising ADORA and CATRA. The horse is startled and neighs]

SHADOW WEAVER. You will *not* do such a thing! [Shoots a spell at them. ADORA pulls CATRA out of the way and stands up between SHADOW WEAVER and CATRA] You can't fight me, little Prince.

[ADORA rushes to take her hunting bow from her horse while evading more spells, and aims at SHADOW WEAVER. One of the spells hits CATRA and she sees her fall]

ADORA. Catra! [Shoots an arrow and misses. Shoots a second one, but it's deflected with magic] No!

[ADORA aims again, crying, and looks back at CATRA. Yells, enraged and drops the bow as a golden light engulfs her]

SHADOW WEAVER. Impossible [Takes a step back]

[On the right side, CATRA slowly transforms into a swan and is awakened by the bright light. It scares her and she escapes deep into the Woods.

CATRA exits]

ADORA. [Now taller and carrying a sword] Go away. [Points at SHADOW WEAVER with the sword] Immediately.

SHADOW WEAVER. Think you can scare me!? [Shoots a spell that is deflected by the sword. Keeps shooting and keeps missing, until one spell bounces back and almost hits her] Curse you and your family!

[SHADOW WEAVER exits]

ADORA. [Falls down, engulfed in light again, and returns to her normal form. Remains a few moments on the ground before recovering] I… I have to tell mom and dad. [Gasps for air as she stands up] Catra, I… [Notices CATRA is nowhere to be found] Catra! [Almost falls down again] No, no. I have to return! [Gets on the horse and starts galloping] Go! Fast!

[ADORA exits]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act I scene 2!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Next act: 1/20!
Another 5 scenes, one per day.
Last act: 1/25!

Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

Characters:
KID ADORA, Prince of Bright Moon
KID CATRA, heir to Half Moon
KID GLIMMER, Princess of Bright Moon
KING MICAH, King of Bright Moon

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act I

Scene 2

SCENE.—*Land of Etheria, ten years before. Inside Bright Moon's castle, midday. The lounge area again, in disarray. Cushions and open books lie everywhere on the ground. Same large colored windows on the back and huge chandelier hanging from the ceiling. The bookshelf to the left is empty. In the center, ten-year-old KID ADORA and KID GLIMMER sit on the cushions lying on the ground with nine-year-old KID CATRA. In the right corner, KING MICAH listens silently, watching over them.*

KID GLIMMER. Yes. Our family used to have a tutor. [Pensive] Um… Light Spinner!

KID ADORA. Yes! Light Spinner! But that was when we were little. We don't remember…

KID CATRA. Oh, my moms talked about that. [Thinking] I heard that they knew her. Oh, and your aunt too!

KID GLIMMER. [Looks down] Oh, auntie… Sometimes I want to go out to the Woods and find her… [Looks up again, smiling ashamedly] But I don't think I can know it's her if she's an animal now.

[KING MICAH flinches and hits a table behind him. KID GLIMMER looks at him, then KID ADORA and KID CATRA look back too. KING MICAH approaches]

KING MICAH. So you're talking about your auntie? [Smiles] I'm sure you would have loved her. [Looks away] I wish she hadn't been cursed.

KID ADORA. [To KID CATRA, gesturing with her hands and using a "spooky" voice] It was Shadow Weaver! She *cursed* our aunt and our tutor!

KID CATRA. [Pensive a moment] I… think my moms have a different story.

KING MICAH. [Interrupts] Well, the truth is one and everyone knows it.

KID ADORA. [Excited] Oh, I heard they were engaged!

[KING MICAH eye-twitches but no one notices]

KID GLIMMER. [Excited too] Oh, right! [To KING MICAH] Maybe they are still together! Happy in the Woods!

[KING MICAH looks away, between ashamed and offended. Nods reluctantly and walks away from them to the right]

KING MICAH. [Aside] I can't believe how that lie has backfired. And how, just how would my sister ever be happy if she has been transformed into a fox!?

[KING MICAH exits]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act I scene 3!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Next act: 1/20!
Another 5 scenes, one per day.
Last act: 1/25!

Chapter 4

Chapter Summary

Characters:
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
NETOSSA, chief of Bright Moon's docks
SPINNERELLA, cursed chief of Bright Moon's docks

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act I

Scene 3

SCENE.—*Land of Etheria, the night before. A tavern in Bright Moon, past midnight. Several wooden tables are set with oil lamps, drunkards and clients are sitting on them, drinking and eating. To the right side, the bar and bartender, a pair of oil lamps sitting at each side of the bar and bottles on the wall behind the bartender. To the back, the entrance to the tavern, small windows, and dirty rock walls. To the left, the wall of the tavern and part of the outside. On the corner, a lone table where a very drunk woman is about to fall asleep while another tries to speak with her.*

SPINNERELLA. Please, please. Just listen to me. It's me! [Cups NETOSSA's face] It's me…

NETOSSA. [Drunk, dragging the words] Who?

SPINNERELLA. Your wife! [Looks around to make sure not to have called anyone's attention and lowers her tone] It's me!

NETOSSA. My… my wife? [Looks up] She's gone… [lets her head fall on the table]

SPINNERELLA. No, no! I never left! *Never*! [Raises NETOSSA's head and holds it between her hands] Look at me, my Love! It's me!

NETOSSA. Yes… You… The sweet dream… [Closes her eyes] You'll be gone in the morning… like always.

SPINNERELLA. No, no, no. I'm not a dream! [Stammering and increasingly desperate] I am real! It's me! [Tears up]

[The door of the tavern opens and closes quickly. A wary woman walks towards SPINNERELLA and NETOSSA]

CASTASPELLA. What are you doing here again! [Grabs SPINNERELLA by the arm] We have to leave! It's almost dawn!

SPINNERELLA. No, I can't! I need her to see I'm real!

CASTASPELLA. [Pulls from SPINNERELLA] She cannot see you after daybreak! Please! Remember! If anyone sees us transform…

SPINNERELLA. But she thinks I'm a dream!

CASTASPELLA. [Lets go of her] I know! But if anyone sees us transform, we will have the Royal Guard on us and your wife won't be safe!

SPINNERELLA. Please, sorceress… [Tears fall and her voice breaks] Please…

CASTASPELLA. [Shakes her head and extends a hand towards SPINNERELLA] You know how this is.

SPINNERELLA. [Sobbing] I can't… continue… like this. [Leans forward to try and kiss NETOSSA's head; NETOSSA moves away] Right… You won't let a dream kiss you… [Looks back at CASTASPELLA and takes her hand]

[CASTASPELLA guides SPINNERELLA out of the tavern so she won't trip while washing away her tears. On the left, outside the tavern, the first rays of sun come out. CASTASPELLA and SPINNERELLA transform into a fox and an albatross and rush back into the Woods]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act I scene 4!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Next act: 1/20!
Another 5 scenes, one per day.
Last act: 1/25!

Chapter 5

Chapter Summary

Characters:
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act I

Scene 4

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, early night. A swan reaches a clearing where CASTASPELLA stops her. All around, there are lush trees, and some boulders sit on the left. Green grass covers the floor and the moon hangs brightly in the sky. A road starts at the center of the clearing and goes deep into the woods.*

CATRA. [In the form of a swan, distressed] Why am I a duck!? Where is Adora!? Where is that… that *witch*!?

CASTASPELLA. [Trying to soothe her] Calm down. Please, give me a moment. [Casts a spell that transforms CATRA back into her form] There. Better now?

CATRA. Why was I a duck!?

CASTASPELLA. A swan, actually.

CATRA. I don't care! What happened to me!? Where's Adora!? And where did that wretched witch go!?

CASTASPELLA. [Sighs] Please, calm down. Why don't you tell me what happened? I can't imagine what you could have done…

CATRA. So this is *my* fault!? I did *nothing* to that witch! I just minded my business and she attacked us!

CASTASPELLA. No, no. Not at all. [Calmly] I didn't mean to say you provoked her. Just, I wonder what of your very innocent actions, totally unrelated to her activities, could have made her feel like she had to curse you.

CATRA. She's crazy or something!

CASTASPELLA. [Gesturing in agreement] She's a bit paranoid, maybe.

CATRA. But why me!?

CASTASPELLA. That, I will find out. For now, just follow the path and you'll arrive at a small sanctuary I have for… everyone in your condition, yes?

CATRA. [Sighs, folds her arms, and taps the floor with her foot] Alright…

[CATRA exits.

CASTASPELLA takes a seat on the boulders and waits for a moment before a shadow surges from the right.

Enter SHADOW WEAVER]

CASTASPELLA. [Stands up when she sees SHADOW WEAVER] You!

SHADOW WEAVER. [Snarky] Miss me?

CASTASPELLA. [Surges forward and pins SHADOW WEAVER against a tree] What was it now!?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Ignores her question and mocks CASTASPELLA] Did I leave you waiting for too long?

CASTASPELLA. [Angry] Now, what the heck could that poor girl have done to you!? Why curse her!?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Serious now and glaring back at CASTASPELLA] That no-one would access the royal family! The same family that rejected *me*! With what right!?

CASTASPELLA. [Surprised] What the fu- [Clears her throat] Why on Etheria are you *still* salty about that!? You should have let that go long ago!

SHADOW WEAVER. Opposite to you, I don't forgive that easily…

CASTASPELLA. Forgive!? No, no. I won't *ever* forgive or forget what you did, but I'm not petty like you. I've put that bullshit behind me already. Why haven't you!?

SHADOW WEAVER. How would I ever do so!? Especially now, with you *right* in front of my eyes…

[A pause]

CASTASPELLA. [Yells] That was *fourteen years ago*! [Tries to calm down] I know you well enough. I know you have never been able to handle frustration. But I can't yet believe that you fucking *cursed me* right there and then! [Yells again] You didn't care that I was your *damned fiancée*! But it's done now! Why are you still making so much of a fuss from something so stupid for what you have made *me* pay!? [Lowers her tone and glares at her] I should be the petty one about this… Why are *you* doing this to a girl who has nothing to do with any of that!?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Laughs sardonically] That's where you're wrong. Not only would that girl be accepted where I was rejected, but also *for the same reason* I was rejected, she would now be accepted. With *what* right!?

CASTASPELLA. [Confused] What!? What the heck are you talking about now!?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Mockingly] Poor innocent Casta. You still don't know, do you? [Smirks] I overheard your dear brother talking with his wife. He said he had just heard of our engagement and, because of that, he refused to allow me to be the Royal Mage. Or to have his sister married to me. So he would only accept *you* as the Royal Mage.

CASTASPELLA. [Stares for a moment] You can't be serious… Of course you're serious. [Furious] As much as I loathe knowing my own brother caused all of this by meddling in my business, I still can't condone what you've done. You should have told me instead of being so reckless…

[SHADOW WEAVER smirks and blasts CASTASPELLA back. CASTASPELLA protects herself with a spell and deflects the actual hit, but SHADOW WEAVER has already escaped when CASTASPELLA looks back at the tree]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act I scene 5!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Next act: 1/20!
Another 5 scenes, one per day.
Last act: 1/25!

Chapter 6

Chapter Summary

Characters:
BOW, cursed stable boy at the castle
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
ELBERON BOY, cursed villager
ELBERON GIRL, cursed villager
SCORPIA, cursed princess
SPINNERELLA, cursed chief of Bright Moon's docks

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act I

Scene 5

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, nighttime. A sanctuary within the woods. A small lagoon to the right, thick bushes and trees all around the clearing, and several boulders here and there, where some people are seated. In the center, a round patch of soil devoid of grass has some mushrooms growing on it. The moon still hangs up in the sky.*

[Enter CATRA, walking slowly and looking around warily]

CATRA. Hello?

BOW. [Approaches] Hello there! Welcome! You were transformed by Shadow Weaver, right?

CATRA. That witch, yeah…

BOW. Don't worry. You're not alone. We are all in the same situation. [Accompanies CATRA closer to the center]

CATRA. So I was told. [Looks around] How many people did that woman curse!?

BOW. Even more than just us, to be honest. [Sighs] You see, we are the only ones with a curse that can't be completely lifted by Castaspella, the sorceress that turned you back into you. And even so, there were more of us but, well, some have passed already.

CATRA. Why is she doing this!?

BOW. I don't know. It seems… random.

CATRA. What happened to you?

BOW. Well, I was around fifteen when it happened. [Sits down on a boulder on the right near the lagoon] I had just begun working at the royal stables and… well, she showed up. I thought she wanted to steal a horse, so I grabbed this… bow and arrows I had hand-crafted and threatened to shoot at her if she got closer.

CATRA. [Laughs] With a bow and arrows!?

BOW. [Chuckles shyly] Yeah, I wasn't thinking clearly. So, she advanced and I shot. And missed… The materials I used weren't the best, really. [Sighs again] She laughed at me, tried to intimidate me, but I didn't back down and fired again. And that was my mistake. She got

offended or something and… turned me into a horse. [Stammers] I ran away, afraid, and tried to go with my dads! But a fox stopped me. [Chuckles softly] The sorceress. She could understand me and promised to help me if I followed her to the Woods. Not only did she turn me back into a human, at least at night, but also fixed things so I can go see my dads and keep working at the stables, you know?

CATRA. So we can trust her.

BOW. Absolutely. I promise. [Pats her shoulder and stands up] Just wait for her here, alright? Now, I have to go to work my shift, but I promise you're in good hands.

[BOW exits]

CATRA. [Walks around shyly and finally sits next to SPINNERELLA] Um, hello. Mind if I sit here?

SPINNERELLA. No, of course. Please. You're new? Were you… transformed recently?

CATRA. [Sighs] Yeah. Just a few hours ago.

SPINNERELLA. So you've met the sorceress.

CATRA. Yes. [Hesitates] Would you mind if I ask you what happened to you?

SPINNERELLA. Oh, well, that's… quite a story, I guess. [Leans back] We were at the docks with my wife, about to set sail early in the morning, and the woman showed up. She… came out of nowhere, I'm not sure what she was doing or when she appeared but, I saw her lurking. [Laughs bitterly] Magic is banned here, you know? So when I saw her preparing a spell, I immediately knew that it had to be that so-called "Shadow Weaver" I had heard about. [Sighs] Fortunately, we were alone, it was too early, so I could freely use my magic to counter her spells. And, truth is, I almost overpowered her! [Looks down] But that's probably what caused all of this. I… Well, I had managed to keep my wife safe because she was already on the ship and I simply blew strong winds on her sails to send her away. Then Shadow Weaver's attacks got more… furious, and finally, one spell hit me.

CATRA. So she transformed you?

SPINNERELLA. Into an albatross. Ironically, my favorite bird. [Chuckles] And I waited there for Netossa, but… She couldn't recognize me. [Sighs] I must have spent a week there at the docks, trying to call her attention, before Castaspella found me. But even when she has given me my true form back for the night, I still can't speak with my wife. I go fly over her ship every day, still help with the winds, and sometimes visit the citadel at night but… she is always at a tavern, depressed, too drunk to remember anything the next day, and never believes it's really me. [Sighs] Just this morning, it happened again. Castaspella has warned us all that revealing the curse to our loved ones can bring them trouble with the Royal Guard enforcing the ban on magic, and we already had to be *very* careful with them due to our own magic so…

CATRA. So you don't have a choice. [Hugs her knees against her chest]

SPINNERELLA. Exactly.

[Enter SCORPIA and approaches with a teary expression]

SCORPIA. Oh, that's so sad! [Sits next to SPINNERELLA, sobbing] You must miss her so much!

SPINNERELLA. I do [Nods and mimics CATRA's position]

CATRA. And what about you? You don't seem… local.

SCORPIA. Oh, no. I'm not from here. It's… a funny story. More in the "weird" sense, not in the "fun" sense. [Clears her throat] You see. I was turned into a *real* scorpion! And… [Hesitates] Well, it's very silly, but I guess I just caught her stealing? From my fiancée's garden, that is. [Rolls eyes and laughs slightly] Yeah, she was stealing flowers. And, apparently, I was… impetuous? That's what she called me. She said I should be a real scorpion and, *poof*! Scorpioni made into a scorpion.

CATRA. That's…

SCORPIA. Wild, right? I was *so* lucky that Perfuma- That is, the princess of Plumeria, [Smiles, blushing] And my fiancée, of course. [Shakes her head] Oh, but, I was saying. I'm lucky she already knew about Castaspella, and this whole thing the sorceress does for the cursed. She found me in the garden and brought me here so I can still be myself at night.

CATRA. I see… And, what was Shadow Weaver stealing? I don't think some little flowers can be useful or valuable, no?

SCORPIA. Oh, that's the silly part. She was stealing *daisies.* [Chuckles] Can you believe it?

[A pause]

CATRA. [Thoughtful] So, you all trust that sorceress fully, right?

SPINNERELLA and **SCORPIA.** Yes.

[CATRA nods, stands up, approaches some kids, and sits down with them]

CATRA. Hey, kiddos. What do you have there?

ELBERON GIRL. The sorceress got us some toys. [Plays with a rag doll, making her walk towards the ELBERON BOY next to her] We're waiting for mamma to visit us.

CATRA. [Kneels next to the ELBERON GIRL] Your mom comes to visit? Does she know that you…

ELBERON GIRL. Are animals now? [Nods]

CATRA. What about not letting people know about the curse or they will be in danger?

ELBERON GIRL. Mommy said she didn't mind.

ELBERON BOY. Mommy is afraid, but she said she doesn't care about the risk. She made a deal with the sorceress and comes to visit sometimes and brings us toys too. [Takes the doll from the ELBERON GIRL and lifts it up] She said the pain of not seeing us is worse…

CATRA. [Caresses the doll's hair with a finger] I get it… [Looks between them, curious] And, how's the sorceress with you two? Is she nice?

ELBERON GIRL. [Smiling] Very! And she helps mamma stay safe!

ELBERON BOY. And brings us food, and keeps us safe…

ELBERON GIRL. She's like a nice auntie!

CATRA. [Chuckles] I see. Thank you. [Stands up and takes a few steps away from them. Thoughtful] Those kids… They probably don't even know what they did to anger that mad woman. [Aside] But at least I know now I can trust that sorceress, no? Everyone here was saved by her, they all trust her. And she saved me too. [Sighs] Well, I'll see. I can't fully trust, but I guess I don't need to be on my guard either.

[Blackout]

[End Act 1]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act II scene 1!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Last act: 1/25!
6 scenes and the epilogue, one per day.

Chapter 7

Chapter Summary

Characters:
ADORA, Prince of Bright Moon
GLIMMER, Princess of Bright Moon

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act II

Scene 1

SCENE.—*Inside Bright Moon's palace, nighttime. A bedroom illuminated by a chandelier hanging from the ceiling. To the left, a large bed with a canopy, a night table, and curtains cover the walls where windows should be. At the back, large uncovered windows open to a balcony. To the right, the door to the room, and bookshelves cover the walls. ADORA and GLIMMER stand in the center of the room.*

ADORA. Alright. I have to tell you this in private.

GLIMMER. Is it about what you told mom and dad? About Shadow Weaver's attack?

ADORA. It's something that happened *during* the attack. [Looks at the door and hesitates] As magic is banned, I'm really afraid of telling them but… I transformed! [Stammers] And had a weird sword I'd never seen, and I don't know how but I just *knew* how to use it! [Shakes excitedly] It reminded me of those bedtime stories they read for us, remember? About She-Ra? And I felt so… *powerful*.

GLIMMER. [Excited, grabs ADORA's arms and shakes her] That's awesome!

ADORA. Yes! [Suddenly wary] But please, don't tell mom and dad.

GLIMMER. [Gestures dismissively] Oh, of course not. I won't. [Excited again, raises a hand in front of ADORA] Look! I have magic too! [Produces some sparkles] See!? I'm with you on this. Oh! Can you transform!?

ADORA. [Stammers shyly] I don't know how to "activate" it, so to speak.

GLIMMER. [Pensive] Oh, I see. It's like my teleportation. I don't know how to do it on purpose.

ADORA. Wow. That's interesting! [Smiles at GLIMMER, then goes to sit on the bed. A pause. GLIMMER sits next to ADORA and holds her hand] I was just… [Sighs] I was with Catra. I found her on the hunting grounds. And we were together when Shadow Weaver attacked us. [Looks at GLIMMER] Remember how I had a crush on Catra? Well, I… told her, and we kissed! And I wanted to bring her home, see how to tell mom and dad that I want her to be my partner…

GLIMMER. And then she attacked?

ADORA. Yes. And when I saw Shadow Weaver hit Catra… I don't know, I simply felt it. [Stands up] Before I knew it, Shadow Weaver was gone and so was Catra. [Gestures at the distance, as if seeing the scene again] I almost fainted when I returned to my own form… [Sighs] But I'm so scared, I can't tell mom and dad…

GLIMMER. [Stands up too and approaches ADORA, worried] We can keep each other's secret, alright? [Looks away blushing] Like… I've been seeing a boy…

ADORA. [Turns towards GLIMMER, curious] Do I know him?

GLIMMER. [Backtracks and sits on the bed, her sight still on ADORA] It's the one who works at the stables at night! [Squeals] His name is Bow, and… well… [Rolls her eyes, blushing again] Not long ago, we kissed! [Expression changes and looks down] Which was… after he fell from the balcony and I discovered I could teleport! [Ashamedly] I don't know how I did it but I caught him and teleported us up again. [Excited again] And so we kissed!

ADORA. [Chuckles] Aw! That's beautiful!

GLIMMER. I don't know what I feel for him yet. But I like him! So, well, we are also trying to keep this all a secret, you know? Which is easy as he only comes to see me at night… Sometimes. And always leaves before dawn. [Sighs, dreamy] Perhaps he rides a horse or something… I always hear galloping when he leaves. [Pensive] Actually, I can't even *find him* during the day. It seems like he only works at night.

[GLIMMER sighs, leans back on the bed, and lies on the mattress. ADORA sits next to her. A pause]

ADORA. What is it?

GLIMMER. Could I have scared him? [Pushes herself up and looks at ADORA] He's been coming less and less. What if I did or said something that…

ADORA. [Interrupting] No! Never! You're so charming! I'm sure it's nothing…

GLIMMER. [Smiles and looks more cheered up] Oh, I should tell you about him! [Both sit up on the bed] Well, to begin with: He wants to be a craftsman but can't pay a Master Blacksmith or a Master Woodworker to have as tutors, so he's self-taught for now. He's been doing the best he can to learn on his own, and experimenting, and he crafted some arrows even! But the materials aren't good so he always misses although he has good aim.

ADORA. Well, it's already impressive as it is.

GLIMMER. Right!? And his work at night is so he can earn money in the meantime, and save enough to pay his tutors! Because his fathers are scholars, most of their money comes from the Academia they are part of… [Looks away shyly] I offered to pay for it instead, but he isn't sure about it. He's afraid of what could happen if anyone ever discovers it…

ADORA. I suppose I understand what he means. But I'm sure he appreciates the offering.

GLIMMER. [Sighs and lies down on the bed again] Do you think he'll come tonight?

ADORA. I don't know. Perhaps. But, knowing Shadow Weaver is out there, perhaps it's better if he stays safe, no?

GLIMMER. And if I go down to the stables to see him?

ADORA. Wouldn't you risk someone finding out?

GLIMMER. [Groans] Fine! I'll stay here…

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act II scene 2!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Last act: 1/25!
6 scenes and the epilogue, one per day.

Chapter 8

Chapter Summary

Characters:
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act II

Scene 2

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, nighttime. To the left, the lake of the royal hunting grounds. The rest is the woods. Lush trees, thick bushes, a path that goes to the right, into the woods, and a shadow lurks at the back. A series of rocks on the ground serve as make-shift burials, marking at least a dozen graves. In the sky, the moon shines brightly.*

[Enter CASTASPELLA.

Walks all the way from the right to the edge of the lake on the left and kneels between the "graves"]

CASTASPELLA. Just what have I done to deserve any of this!? Was it falling in love with her!? Was it chasing after the dream of becoming a magic tutor myself!? Was it my ambition? Going on despite being told I was not made to be a sorceress? [Holds her head between both hands] How could the woman that brightened my world become the one to cast this tragic fate on the kingdom? On my family and myself! [Gestures with both hands, looking up at the moon] Am I paying for something!? Did any of them pay for something!? Is she but an instrument of fate!? Am I just looking for something to justify all this cruelty!? [Looks down again and falls on her knees, both hands on the ground in front of her to support her weight] I no longer know the woman I love so deeply. I cannot understand what she does or why, and I can't walk that path with her. Even if I were willing to, she wouldn't let me. [Sobs] I understand. She no longer loves me, yet she helped me enough to survive. She sees me as the enemy now, yet she has never recast the curses I lifted, never came for those I protect despite knowing where my sanctuary is… [Shakes her head] I do not understand… [A pause] Does she even know what she's doing!? All the people I have lost!? [Looks around among the rocks marking the graves] Does she know how many have died because of the animals she turned them into!? Because of how short-lived those animals were, their human years caused some to die within a day! Others had years but I failed to lift their curses in time and now lay here with the others… [Punches the ground] I have failed so many times! Does she know that!? Does she know she could have sparked a war with Plumeria!? That Scorpioni princess would have died if it weren't because her scorpioni nature counters the short life-span of the actual scorpion she was turned into. [Holds her head with both hands again] And now this!? Transforming the Half Moon heir into a *swan*!? Is she serious!? This can be a disaster! [Falls on her hands] This will be a disaster, won't it? I will lose yet another one. A war will break out. No one will be safe… But she will still be herself. And because she was aggravated, we all shall fall with her… [A pause. Sighs and stands up] I still have some time for a final talk, don't I? [Looks over the lake into the distance] You better have time for a little chat, brother…

[CASTASPELLA exits.

The shadow lurking at the back comes forward and reveals it to be SHADOW WEAVER. She looks in the direction CASTASPELLA left but remains silent and exits too]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act II scene 3!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Last act: 1/25!
6 scenes and the epilogue, one per day.

Chapter 9

Chapter Summary

Characters:
ADORA, Prince of Bright Moon
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
GLIMMER, Princess of Bright Moon
GUARDS of Bright Moon castle
KING MICAH, King of Bright Moon
PERFUMA, Princess of Plumeria
QUEEN ANGELLA, Queen of Bright Moon
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act II

Scene 3

SCENE.—*Bright Moon's palace, nighttime. A bit of the outside to the left with some trees marking the beginning of the Whispering Woods. To the center and right, the inside of a large room, illuminated with chandeliers. To the right, the throne. At the back, large windows. ADORA, GLIMMER, princess PERFUMA, standing at the center in front of KING MICAH and QUEEN ANGELLA sitting on the throne.*

PERFUMA. But I don't understand, Your Majesty. If you knew there was a way to help the people being cursed, and that way implied the use of magic, why wouldn't you allow it!?

QUEEN ANGELLA. Magic is the cause of our disgrace. Our family has suffered more than enough already, and I will not allow more harm to come to any of us just because there is a *chance* magic can help the cursed. We shall find other ways to help our people. For now, the Royal Guard will protect everyone by keeping any and all kinds of magic restricted.

PERFUMA. I understand your pain, but you forget I have also suffered such disgrace. The curses don't just beset your kingdom! [Almost crying] I too have lost someone dear to me because of Shadow Weaver's curses! Yet I have not banned magic in Plumeria! If you don't do something to help…

QUEEN ANGELLA. [Interrupting] It is not us who should solve this. Our only duty is to protect our people, and that is what our laws intend. [A pause] Now, if that is all, Princess Perfuma, I will have to ask you to leave. After all, we are making an exception by accepting your presence here.

PERFUMA. [Resigned] I see. Then I shall go. Good night, Your Majesties.

[KING MICAH and QUEEN ANGELLA stand up and exit]

GLIMMER. Mom! Dad! Wait! [Looks back at ADORA] I'll speak with them. Can you walk Perfuma to her carriage?

ADORA. Of course. Go.

[Glimmer exits]

ADORA. [Starts walking with PERFUMA towards the exit at the left] Please excuse them. What happened had a great impact on them. I personally don't know well what happened, but unless it is fixed, I don't see how they would ever lift the ban on magic.

PERFUMA. Don’t worry, Adora. I understand. [Stops outside the palace and takes ADORA’s hands] But know that this *can* be undone. I know it.

[PERFUMA exits.

Between the trees, CATRA can be seen along with a shadow nearby]

ADORA. Perhaps Princess Perfuma is right. The curses our kingdom is suffering can be stopped, there must be a way! But can that bring Catra back to me? [Sighs] If only I knew what to do, where to find her… She disappeared after our encounter with Shadow Weaver, so she may have fallen victim to a curse too! What if I find her but she's cursed!? What will I do!? Can I do anything!? [Grunts and looks at her hands] This magic I have… It could be able to do something, but I… don't know what to do with it… [Sighs] If only I could convince Mother of lifting the ban on magic… If only I had someone who could teach me… [Shakes head] But first I should focus on finding Catra. [Pensive] Although, how will I do it when all eyes are on me? I am constantly bothered with the upcoming ball preparations… I'll have to delay my search until it passes. [Hugs herself] I only wanted her to come with me… [Looks at the Woods] Catra… Where are you? [Notices someone between the trees and becomes wary] Who is there!? Show yourself! [Takes a defensive stance]

[CATRA comes out from between the trees and approaches slowly.

A red light covers ADORA’s eyes for a moment but she doesn’t notice]

CATRA. Adora? [Hesitant] It’s just me.

ADORA. Who are you!? [Frowns and keeps her defensive stance]

CATRA. [Stammers] What!? It’s me! Don’t you recognize me?

ADORA. Not another step! I don’t know who you think you are but I do not know you!

CATRA. [Stops and stammers again, looking afraid] Adora, it’s me, Catra!

ADORA. Don’t make me laugh! You’re not her! Are you the one who took her away!? Did you overhear me!? Speak or leave!

CATRA. But it’s me! I’m back! [Takes another step forward]

ADORA. Enough! Guards!

[A pair of GUARDS come out from the palace and point their lances at CATRA.

CATRA runs away and exits.

ADORA returns to the palace with the GUARDS, who stand guard again, and ADORA continues walking.

ADORA exits.

Outside, the shadow at the back moves forward, revealing SHADOW WEAVER]

SHADOW WEAVER. Now, dear Prince, let's see how you break the spell if you can't even recognize her with my illusions…

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act II scene 4!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Last act: 1/25!
6 scenes and the epilogue, one per day.

Chapter 10

Chapter Summary

Characters:
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
KING MICAH, King of Bright Moon
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act II

Scene 4

SCENE.—*Land of Etheria, fourteen years before. Inside Bright Moon's palace, nighttime. A room illuminated by a chandelier. To the right, a large bed with a canopy, a night table at each side, and curtains on the walls, hiding windows. At the back, a pair of large windows open to a balcony. To the left, the door, a closet, and a bookshelf.*

[From the balcony, enter SHADOW WEAVER and goes straight to the bookshelf, looking for something]

SHADOW WEAVER. You dare do this to *me*. After everything I've done for your family! I shall take what's mine by right. [Grabs a book from the shelf and looks through it quickly] Yes. I will take this now. Dared to take the title from me solely because I was going to marry your sister, Micah? You will regret the moment you decided to betray me. And I'm sure you knew, Castaspella. You were lucky I couldn't confront you today before the ceremony. Or perhaps unlucky? [Laughs] I will make all of you pay for this betrayal. [Hears footsteps nearing] He must be coming…

[SHADOW WEAVER conceals herself with magic and remains next to the closet.

Enter KING MICAH through the door. Right after, enter CASTASPELLA through the balcony]

KING MICAH. Sister!? [Rushes to hug CASTASPELLA] How!?

CASTASPELLA. I managed to lift the curse. But not fully. This is only temporary.

KING MICAH. I'm so… happy to see you well. [Takes a quick look at the door] But I must warn you: you have to leave. You can't be seen in the kingdom ever again.

CASTASPELLA. What!? Why!? Micah, what happened?

KING MICAH. After you fled and Light Spinner disappeared, Angella banned magic in all the kingdom, and every sorcerer has been forced to pledge never to use their magic or leave Bright Moon forever.

CASTASPELLA. What!? But…

KING MICAH. [Interrupting] We won't use our magic anymore, and the girls won't ever learn magic either.

CASTASPELLA. Micah, you can't do this to them! Magic is a part of who they are!

KING MICAH. I have no choice. This happening again… it's a risk we're not willing to take.

CASTASPELLA. So… what do you expect me to do?

KING MICAH. Try to find refuge in a neighbouring kingdom, maybe? [Quickly looks at the door again] You can visit me whenever Angella is not around, but you must be careful, alright?

CASTASPELLA. [Serious] I see. [Walks backwards] In that case, goodbye, Micah.

[CASTASPELLA exits.

KING MICAH goes to sit on the edge of the bed]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act II scene 5!
One new scene each day (5 scenes total)
Last act: 1/25!
6 scenes and the epilogue, one per day.

Chapter 11

Chapter Summary

Characters:
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
KING MICAH, King of Bright Moon
QUEEN ANGELLA, Queen of Bright Moon

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act II

Scene 5

SCENE.—*Inside Bright Moon's palace, near dawn. Same room as before, nothing has changed. The windows remain open to a balcony, the room is still illuminated by the chandelier hanging from the ceiling. KING MICAH is laying on the bed, resting.*

[Enter CASTASPELLA through the balcony.

Knocks on the window to call KING MICAH's attention]

KING MICAH. [Gets up and approaches CASTASPELLA] What are you doing here? You know what will happen if Angella…

CASTASPELLA. [Interrupting] I don't care. You and I have to talk, Micah. About what happened a decade and a half ago.

KING MICAH. You can't really mean…

CASTASPELLA. [Annoyed] Of course I do. It's high time we spoke about that.

KING MICAH. [Sighs] What about that?

CASTASPELLA. I just learnt the reason why *you* decided I had to be the Royal Mage.

KING MICAH. So it's that, eh? [Folds arms] Can you really blame me, Sis?

CASTASPELLA. You have the gall of treating me like *family* now? Much of a guilty conscience?

KING MICAH. She was our tutor!

CASTASPELLA. *Your* tutor, Micah!

KING MICAH. [Gestures, indignant] You barely knew each other for, what? Three years?

CASTASPELLA. Is this how we're going to do this? Alright then. [Folds arms] Allow me to revise history: you were ten when she, the Royal tutor, discovered and took you in as pupil, am I right?

KING MICAH. Yes.

CASTASPELLA. I was a baby, she didn't even know of my existence. Four years later, I was six, barely dabbled in magic; you were fourteen, and the brightest sorcerer apprentice ever to have existed. Light Spinner's star pupil, on par with royalty. Am I right?

KING MICAH. Yes.

CASTASPELLA. By the time I was sixteen, I had already had three different tutors. [Gestures, annoyed] All of them got frustrated, because I was a *disappointment*. In all that time, you kept thriving as Light Spinner's assistant, *the* distinguished sorcerer, the first commoner to ever access the royal circles, and because of that you met Angella. Is that correct?

KING MICAH. Yes.

CASTASPELLA. And didn't you two get engaged within two years?

KING MICAH. [Sighs] Yes.

CASTASPELLA. And… [Folds arms again]

KING MICAH. And Glimmer was born.

CASTASPELLA. [Places both hands on her hips] Indeed. You two married, Angella invited us all to move here to the palace. Now Light Spinner had no need to travel to our village, yet you made the decision to no longer be under her tutelage. I was eighteen, struggling to become a tutor despite having always been "a disappointment", and for three more years, failed to advance at all. But, you were so happy with Glimmer, you never really had any interest in how I was doing.

KING MICAH. Sis, I…

CASTASPELLA. [Gestures for him to stop] No, no. I'm arriving at the interesting part. By then I was twenty-one, and running out of options, until I remembered Light Spinner's literally the one to have taught the royal family since forever. Everyone had heard of her renowned tutoring skills, and now she was free to teach someone other than you, so I sought her out.

KING MICAH. [Angrily] And. Got. Engaged.

CASTASPELLA. [Gestures, indignant] And *finally* made progress! Micah! I wasn't a disappointment! She showed me I had only had awful tutors! Within three years I was ready to teach your six years old daughters; Glimmer, whom we know is bound to be extremely powerful, and Adora, whom you had adopted a year before and had impressive magical potential.

KING MICAH. You don't understand…

CASTASPELLA. No, *you* don't understand. It didn't matter who was the Royal Mage. We both knew well enough, Light Spinner has never been able to handle frustration. You should have known what would happen! Besides, we all expected her to be the Royal Mage, so I

would be your daughters' tutor, technically taking the place she would leave vacant. Why did you have to…

KING MICAH. [Interrupting] It's done now. And how did you even learn it was me who made the decision? [CASTASPELLA remains silent] *She* told you… You still talk to her?

CASTASPELLA. She cursed a young woman today, Micah. I went to confront her to know why. It was because of the same reason you decided to reject her.

KING MICAH. Adora told us Shadow Weaver had attacked her. You mean that was… [A pause] So Adora has someone?

CASTASPELLA. Barely. If we don't break the curse…

KING MICAH. [Interrupting] If Adora really loves her, we could work on a way to break the curse. She'll sure wait, she's a very loyal girl, and this is the first time I hear of her being in love.

CASTASPELLA. I'm not worried about the transformation itself, Micah. [Sighs] She's a swan. And she's around your daughters' age.

KING MICAH. You mean… So, how long does she have?

CASTASPELLA. I don't know. But if the curse isn't lifted soon, she won't make it. [Looks away, tearing up] You have no idea how many I have lost because they were turned into short-lived animals. I can't lose anyone else, Micah. And I can't believe… this all happened because…

KING MICAH. [Interrupting] Wait, but then… How- You're a red fox, you- they only live five years…

CASTASPELLA. Yes… I was actually dying when I arrived at the woods. I- I think… Well, no, I *know* she did something. [Looks down] And- And I begged her to do the same for them too… But she only said "they are not you" every time. It was so unfair…

KING MICAH. I'm sorry.

CASTASPELLA. Don't be sorry, it won't fix anything now. [Serious] If you regret it, let Adora know the truth. Convince Angella to lift the ban on magic. And help me save this girl.

[Footsteps can be heard coming. CASTASPELLA and KING MICAH exchange a look and CASTASPELLA backtracks.

CASTASPELLA exits.

Enter QUEEN ANGELLA]

QUEEN ANGELLA. Micah. [Approaches] Is everything alright? You look down.

KING MICAH. [Stares at the rising sun] It's nothing, don't worry.

QUEEN ANGELLA. Do you have anything to tell me, Dear?

[A pause]

KING MICAH. No, nothing. Please, don't worry.

[Blackout]

[End Act 2]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act III scene 1!
One new scene each day (6 scenes total + Epilogue)

Chapter 12

Chapter Summary

Characters:
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act III

Scene 1

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, sunset. Lush trees all around, a clearing in the middle. The moon rises while the sun disappears, and stars begin populating the sky. A red fox runs into the clearing, followed by a raven that catches it. Right after, the fox transforms into CASTASPELLA and the raven has to release her. It then transforms into SHADOW WEAVER who leaps on CASTASPELLA and pins her against a tree without really holding her. At the back, a hidden figure observes.*

SHADOW WEAVER. I will *not* stop just because you're asking kindly. [Moves closer] It's more appealing to keep pissing you off.

[SHADOW WEAVER kisses CASTASPELLA]

CASTASPELLA. [Kisses back for a moment. Feels SHADOW WEAVER's hands on her waist and pushes SHADOW WEAVER away, annoyed but flustered] No, no. Stop. [Voice almost broken] You've lost your right to kiss or touch me.

SHADOW WEAVER. [Smirks] What a shame you still want me…

CASTASPELLA. *Want*? No, I- [Angry] *You* want me. I? I still *love you*; which is far worse.

[A pause]

SHADOW WEAVER. [Approaches, smirking] Except that, right now, I believe you need me again, don't you?

CASTASPELLA. [Blushes] I-I don't. *You* "need" me… Why not say it as it is?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Gently grabs one of CASTASPELLA's locks of hair] Fine, I suppose I'm the one who'd like to have you now. Just forget about your morals for a moment; this is but an equivalent exchange. No one will know or judge you.

CASTASPELLA. [Sorrowful, whispering] Curse you…

SHADOW WEAVER. [Smirks] I'll take that as a yes.

[SHADOW WEAVER extends hand for CASTASPELLA to take. SHADOW WEAVER and CASTASPELLA exit to the left.

From the back, enter CATRA.]

CATRA. What exactly did I just see!? Is that sorceress betraying us!? How long has this been happening!? Do the others know!? [Pensive] This is bad. What am I supposed to do? Should I tell the others!? Will they believe me!? They all trust her… *I* trusted her enough… But this!? [Indignant] How can this be!? Who is she with!? Fraternizing with the enemy in this way… Is their supposed animosity all a lie!? Are we part of a larger plan!? What do they win doing this to us!? [Pensive again] No. I have to let everyone know. If she's betraying us, we need to be on our guard. What's more! We should face her! Before it's too late for us! I'll wait for everyone to be back and then tell them about this!

[CATRA exits]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act III scene 2!
One new scene each day (6 scenes total + Epilogue)

Chapter 13

Chapter Summary

Characters:
BOW, cursed stable boy at the castle
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
ELBERON BOY, cursed villager
ELBERON GIRL, cursed villager
SCORPIA, cursed princess
SPINNERELLA, cursed chief of Bright Moon's docks
Other people

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act III

Scene 2

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, break of dawn. The sanctuary within the woods again. A small lagoon to the right, thick bushes and trees all around the clearing, and several boulders here and there. The sun lightens the sky. Various animals arrive from the left and right. In the center, CATRA stands as a swan on the round patch of soil devoid of grass, discussing with BOW as a horse.*

CATRA. [Indignant] I saw it! I'm not making shit up! Where do you think she is at right now?

BOW. [Shakes head] There is no way; Castaspella isn't a traitor, and she was cursed like us.

SCORPIA. [Nervous, clicking her pincers] I… don't think I can say anything here, I don't know the sorceress that much, but… I'm sure there's an explanation, right?

CATRA. You're all just- You should have been there!

[All the present, transformed into animals, start whispering.

Enter CASTASPELLA]

CASTASPELLA. [Confused at the commotion, stands on two legs as a fox] What's going on here?

CATRA. [Jumps back and takes a hostile stance, wings open menacingly] You're a traitor! I saw you!

CASTASPELLA. [Genuinely confused] Saw me?

CATRA. Where do you come from, huh? Where have you spent the whole night until sunrise!?

CASTASPELLA. [Realizes, sighs, and moves to sit down nearby, giving CATRA space] I suppose you were there then?

CATRA. I was following Shadow Weaver; imagine my surprise when it turned out she was on her way to meet you!

CASTASPELLA. In fact, she was chasing me but… You see: it is… more complicated than you think.

CATRA. She *cursed* us! What is there to- *How* is it “complicated”?

CASTASPELLA. [Hesitant] Because she was- Technically still is… my fiancée.

[CATRA, speechless, looks around. The youngsters are surprised while the elders are looking away with sad expressions]

CATRA. That’s… Light Spinner. You knew… I- My mothers were right. But- But she *cursed* you too!

CASTASPELLA. [Sighs] I was the *first* person she cursed…

CATRA. Why!?

CASTASPELLA. She thought- When I was given the title of Royal Mage instead of her… She thought I knew Micah wouldn’t allow her to have the title, so me not making an effort to win it was all a farce. In fact, I wasn’t because the deal was that she’d be Royal Mage while I’d take over her role of tutor. But- Well… she’s never taken defeat right. I-I couldn’t even complain or reject the title because she… immediately lashed out, called me a sly fox and… here I am. Cursed to be a fox. [Laughs bitterly]

CATRA. [Looking down, pained] And you still love her…

CASTASPELLA. [Nods] Deeply…

CATRA. I apologize. I shouldn’t have spoken without knowing. Much less get everyone involved. [Sits down]

CASTASPELLA. No need to apologize. [Moves closer] Only those who recall the time before this all happened know about this. The rest… I should have told you.

BOW. We understand. [Taps the ground with a hoof]

SCORPIA. Oh! Now I get it! Silly me… Perfuma did mention something about it but I didn’t understand.

CASTASPELLA. Ah yes, she knows.

SPINNERELLA. I had only heard the official story… About Light Spinner being a victim too. I never dared ask you about her but now… I see why you understand my pain…

CASTASPELLA. To be totally honest with you all, I feel responsible. And taking care of you is the least I can do.

CATRA. I won’t doubt you again, Sorceress. And them? They trust you unconditionally. You can be sure.

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act III scene 3!
One new scene each day (6 scenes total + Epilogue)

Chapter 14

Chapter Summary

Characters:
BOW, cursed stable boy at the castle
CATRA, heir to Half Moon

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act III

Scene 3

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, afternoon. The sanctuary within the woods again. A small lagoon to the right, thick bushes and trees all around the clearing, and several boulders here and there with small animals standing on them. The sky is illuminated by the sun, which is already down between the trees. A horse enters the scene galloping and stops in front of a swan.*

BOW. [Huffs] I saw the palace. There are already preparations for the party. It looks like it will be a grand ball inside the castle.

CATRA. Nothing outside? That's a shame…

BOW. Nothing outside, no. But I also heard a conversation between the Prince and the Princess! [Raises his front legs slightly, and stomps the ground happily] They expect us to go! And, as the party is at night, I believe we can!

CATRA. [Excited] Really!? [Hesitates] Oh, but… I can't. The other night I tried to speak with Adora outside the palace and she… couldn't recognize me. [Sits down] What would be the point?

BOW. She couldn't recognize you? Did something happen?

CATRA. Nothing that I know of! Unless something of all this transformation magic is messing up with me… [Flaps wings, distressed] All I know is that she isn't seeing *me* and thinks I'm the one who, well, took *me* away.

BOW. Sounds like some sort of illusion magic messing with the Prince's head.

CATRA. It must be that witch! But why!? It isn't happening to any of you…

BOW. As far as I know, no. We can all be recognized…

CATRA. I'll go talk with the sorceress. Perhaps she can undo that, or at least may know something, right?

BOW. Sounds like a good plan, yes. Do you know where to find her?

CATRA. I have an idea, yes.

BOW. [Huffs again] Then I'll wait for you here…

[CATRA flaps her wings once and runs into the Woods.

CATRA exits]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act III scene 4!
One new scene each day (6 scenes total + Epilogue)

Chapter 15

Chapter Summary

Characters:
BOW, cursed stable boy at the castle
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act III

Scene 4

SCENE.—*The Whispering Woods, late afternoon. The clearing in the woods again. All around, there are lush trees, and some boulders sit on the left. Green grass covers the floor and the sky is illuminated in tones of orange and pink. A road starts at the center of the clearing and goes deep into the woods. A red fox sits on the boulders to the left of the scene.*

[Enter CATRA]

CATRA. Sorceress!

CASTASPELLA. [Surprised] Oh, Catra! [Stammers] What are you doing here?

CATRA. I have a problem I forgot to tell you about: I tried to speak with Adora the other night, but she couldn't recognize me!

CASTASPELLA. [Looks around before approaching CATRA] Sounds like an illusion spell on Adora…

CATRA. I- Sorry, is this a bad moment?

CASTASPELLA. Not yet, fortunately…

CATRA. You're expecting her.

CASTASPELLA. After this morning, I realized a few things and I have to confront her about them.

CATRA. Then I'll be short. I think that, if she sees me transform, she'll be able to recognize me. Perhaps, seeing that can break the illusion? [Stammers] Or at least she'll believe it's me if she realizes there's a spell on her?

CASTASPELLA. [Looking down] I'm sorry, Catra, but that's not how magic works… And revealing yourself like that, exposing your transformation, it's dangerous. Especially if you're showing it to the daughter of the Queen who prohibited magic in the first place! It will only make everything worse…

CATRA. You don't understand. Adora would never tell her mother! I can trust her!

CASTASPELLA. We can't be sure. I insist. Don't do it.

CATRA. I *do* know! [Grunts] I don't know why I'm asking you for permission in the first place!

[CATRA exits]

CASTASPELLA. Catra! Wait!

[CASTASPELLA lowers her head and curls up until a shadow appears.

Enter SHADOW WEAVER]

SHADOW WEAVER. [As a Raven] Look at you, poor little creature [Approaches] What have you come to beg me for, this time?

CASTASPELLA. [Raises her head and warily sits up] We need to talk.

SHADOW WEAVER. About?

CASTASPELLA. What you're doing! You also charmed the Prince!?

SHADOW WEAVER. I did.

CASTASPELLA. I had come, once more, to beg the woman I knew to undo all of this! But you… always manage to make everything worse!

SHADOW WEAVER. I'd say it's quite endearing how you still believe in me, but I actually find that disgusting.

CASTASPELLA. Hah! Oh, no, no, no. Believe in you!? [Annoyed] I've long lost the naïve hope that you'd one day realize your mistakes and regret it all, undo your curses and apologize. Hah! I know you well enough, I should have never hoped so, yet I *so* wanted to believe. But I no longer do. Don't mistake my stupid undying love for you with mere "hope". I just love you too much to abandon you. [Cocky] And don't think I haven't noticed you lurking around my spot in the forest. I knew you wouldn't attempt to hurt us, and you never did. That's the woman I came to talk to.

SHADOW WEAVER. I simply had no reasons. It doesn't make your "love" any more justified.

CASTASPELLA. As I said, I know you well enough. That's why I'm sure the woman I knew is somewhere inside you still. When you promised to take revenge, every time you said cursing us into animal forms was so it would be easier to finish the job later, I could see you really intended it. Which means, if you never did, it's because a part of you might still love me. For how long have you tried to kill it?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Visibly nervous] Whatever makes you think I care enough about that stupid feeling to want to get rid of it?

CASTASPELLA. Or you just can't. [Warningly] But, me loving you doesn't mean I'll hold back or turn a blind eye. I won't let you cross the line, and even if I can't match your power,

I'll still go after you, doing my best to undo your damned bullshit.

SHADOW WEAVER. [Shakes head slightly and smirks] Then good luck with that… [Blends into the shadows] Or not.

[SHADOW WEAVER exits]

CASTASPELLA. [Stands on two legs and extends a paw forwards as if intending to stop SHADOW WEAVER from leaving; hesitates and sits down again] Perhaps it was a mistake. Perhaps I shouldn't keep trying… The woman I knew is gone. She feels so close, yet it's just me deceiving myself. I should have known. But what if I'm already close enough? Should I appeal to her one more time? Would there be a point?

[Enter BOW, galloping]

BOW. Sorceress! We have a problem!

CASTASPELLA. [Jumps to stand up] What happened!?

BOW. Catra never returned! I went to look for her, and she's outside the palace! She's there singing! And it's almost nightfall!

CASTASPELLA. She's running out of time! I have to do something *now*! [Stands on two legs in front of BOW] Gather everyone at the sanctuary and wait for me… I'll be back soon. I can still play one last card with that woman…

[Runs deeper into the woods, to the left.

CASTASPELLA exits.

BOW gallops down the path in the middle.

BOW exits]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act III scene 5!
One new scene each day (6 scenes total + Epilogue)

Chapter 16

Chapter Summary

Characters:
BOW, cursed stable boy at the castle
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
ELBERON BOY, cursed villager
ELBERON GIRL, cursed villager
SCORPIA, cursed princess
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress
SPINNERELLA, cursed chief of Bright Moon's docks

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act III

Scene 5

SCENE.—*Outside Bright Moon's palace, nightfall. The gates can be seen in the back, along with the setting sun. A swan is flying near the windows, singing for a moment, before it falls to the ground and transforms back into CATRA. A group of animals rushes into the scene before transforming back into themselves.*

[CASTASPELLA rushes to pick up CATRA]

CASTASPELLA. [Yelling] She better not be dead or I will kill you myself! [Returns to the group carrying CATRA in her arms] She's barely breathing… [To SHADOW WEAVER] She has no more time! Lift the curse! We have a deal!

SHADOW WEAVER. First, fulfill your end of the agreement. *Then* I'll tell you how to lift the curse.

CASTASPELLA. I cannot believe I fell for your trap. You won't tell us, will you?

SHADOW WEAVER. I will. [Takes a step forward] But, as I said, first get me to confront the Royal Family. I wouldn't break a promise to you…

CASTASPELLA. [Sighs] Very well… [Turns to address the group] Everyone, we're going into the castle. Your families and loved ones will be there, for this is a public event, but I need you all to stay with me, in case the Royal Guard is called to capture us.

ELBERON GIRL. Will we return with mommy? We won't be animals anymore?

CASTASPELLA. [Sight fixed on SHADOW WEAVER] After today, we all recover our lives.

SHADOW WEAVER. Yes, yes. [Gesturing] Now stop wasting time, will you!?

CASTASPELLA. Let's go.

[Everyone walks towards the gates at the back]

[Blackout]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Act III scene 6!
One new scene each day (6 scenes total + Epilogue)

Chapter 17

Chapter Summary

Characters:
ADORA, Prince of Bright Moon
BOW, cursed stable bow at the castle
CASTASPELLA, cursed sorceress
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
ELBERON BOY, cursed villager
ELBERON GIRL, cursed villager
GLIMMER, Princess of Bright Moon
GUARDS of Bright Moon castle
KING MICAH, King of Bright Moon
NETOSSA, chief of Bright Moon's docks
PERFUMA, Princess of Plumeria
QUEEN ANGELLA, Queen of Bright Moon
SCORPIA, cursed princess
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress
SPINNERELLA, cursed chief of Bright Moon's docks
Other people

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Act III

Scene 6

SCENE.—*Inside Bright Moon's palace, nighttime. The main hall, where a ball is taking place. Music plays in the background. Large decorated windows at the back, several chandeliers hanging from the ceiling, and the throne to the right. Guards are standing at both sides of the gates to the left, where some tables have been set. In the center, several guests mingle. Princess PERFUMA stands near the gates, next to the tables where NETOSSA sits, along with BOW's fathers and several other guests. At the center stand ADORA and GLIMMER, in formal attires. To the right, QUEEN ANGELLA and KING MICAH sit on the throne.*

ADORA. I don't think she will come…

GLIMMER. [Noticeably nervous] She may arrive! Give her some time… The ball just began. [Stammers] I'm sure she will come, and so will Bow. They… they will…

ADORA. I hope.

GLIMMER. Adora… Remember how I said I don't know what I feel for him? [Sighs] Now I do. I'm really afraid he doesn't… you know…

[The gates open abruptly, the music stops.

Enter CASTASPELLA, SHADOW WEAVER, and the group of cursed people]

QUEEN ANGELLA. [Stands from the throne, angry] What is the meaning of this!? [KING MICAH stops her, holding her hand. QUEEN ANGELLA stares at CASTASPELLA, surprised] You are… [Shakes head] Magic is banned in this kingdom! No sorcerer is allowed here! [Looks at SHADOW WEAVER] Much less you. [Yells] Guards!

[A group of GUARDS surrounds them but are frightened by SHADOW WEAVER]

KING MICAH. [Stands next to QUEEN ANGELLA] How dare you, Shadow Weaver, come here after tormenting our kingdom for the past fourteen years!?

ADORA. [To GLIMMER] What's going on!? How is your aunt back!? And who is she carrying!?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Smirking] Ah… the Royal Family. What a *pleasure* to see you all. [Focuses on ADORA] Tell me, little Prince, who do you see? [Laughs] Your father once said "Love blinds people", and so are you…

CASTASPELLA. [To SHADOW WEAVER] Stop playing games. We are surrounded.

SHADOW WEAVER. Very well. [A red light shines on ADORA's eyes for a moment] See clearly, dear Prince…

ADORA. [Surprised] Catra! [Angry, approaches] Let me through! What have you done to her!?

[A light envelops ADORA and she becomes taller, wields a sword, and points it at SHADOW WEAVER. The guests all gasp in surprise and start whispering]

SHADOW WEAVER. [Laughs sardonically and addresses QUEEN ANGELLA and KING MICAH] You are such hypocrites! Banning magic when your own daughters have magic! When *you both* have magic!

ADORA. [Moves her sword closer] I asked you a question!

CASTASPELLA. [Stepping between ADORA and SHADOW WEAVER] Please wait! [To SHADOW WEAVER] What are you doing!? Do you want to get yourself killed!?

SHADOW WEAVER. [To CASTASPELLA] Perhaps.

CASTASPELLA. Just stop taunting and tell us what to do to break your damned curses!

ADORA. Curse!? [Holds the sword tighter] Undo it! Now!

SHADOW WEAVER. [Mocking] Ah, but you can do so yourself, Prince. [Looks at KING MICAH] Oh yes, what was this other thing you said? "This isn't really love but rather mere confusion". Alright then let's see who is confused… Let your own daughter here prove you wrong.

[CASTASPELLA looks surprised at SHADOW WEAVER and extends the fainted CATRA towards ADORA, who lowers the sword to take CATRA in her arms. ADORA carries her to the back, the guests move aside to let her pass, and kneels on the ground before kissing CATRA. A sparkling halo surrounds CATRA, and she wakes up]

CATRA. [Afraid] What!? Who!?

ADORA. Calm down, it's just me… [Transforms back into herself] It's just me.

CATRA. Adora!

[ADORA and CATRA embrace while everyone looks in surprise]

CASTASPELLA. [To SHADOW WEAVER] How hypocritical of *you*. Weren't you the one who said "love is a distraction"?

SHADOW WEAVER. And if you hadn't convinced me otherwise, I would have agreed with your brother, and none of this would have happened…

[GLIMMER finally reacts, passes through the guests to approach the group, and sees CASTASPELLA]

GLIMMER. Auntie!

CASTASPELLA. Glimmer!

[BOW suddenly looks up and reaches the front of the group]

BOW. Glimmer!

[GLIMMER teleports next to BOW and immediately kisses him. After BOW embraces GLIMMER and kisses her back, a sparkling halo surrounds him]

GLIMMER. I thought you had left me!

BOW. Never. [BOW's fathers arrive from behind and embrace him before he sees them] Dads!

[SPINNERELLA starts looking through the crowd of guests]

SPINNERELLA. Netossa!? Has someone seen my wife!?

NETOSSA. [Lifts her head from the table] Spinny? [Sees SPINNERELLA and stands up] Spinny! [SPINERELLA rushes to the table but NETOSSA stops her from approaching] No… You must be a dream again…

SPINNERELLA. No, no, no. It's me! [Catches NETOSSA's hand] See!? It's me! I'm here!

NETOSSA. [Sobs] Spinny!

[NETOSSA hugs SPINNERELLA and they kiss. Again, a sparkling halo envelops SPINNERELLA. Behind them, the ELBERON GIRL and the ELBERON BOY find their parents and they hug. When their parents kiss their heads, the same sparkling halo surrounds them]

CASTASPELLA. [Looking around] At long last… [Notices SCORPIA standing awkwardly at the back and gestures at her, smiling] Go! [Watches as SCORPIA rushes to princess PERFUMA who kisses her face repeatedly, causing the same sparkling halo around her] Much better… [To SHADOW WEAVER] Well! Where's my kiss?

SHADOW WEAVER. [Looking away, arms fold, smirking] Your protegees have been uncursed. End of the deal…

CASTASPELLA. [Squints and yells] Hey! [SHADOW WEAVER moves away and CASTASPELLA chases after her] Come on! You can't leave me cursed! You better kiss me right now!

SHADOW WEAVER. [Still moving out of reach] Make me!

CASTASPELLA. That's the idea! [Catches SHADOW WEAVER with magic] And it better not be a lustful kiss this time…

SHADOW WEAVER. Smart… [Grabs CASTASPELLA by the arms and pins her to the wall behind her] You're my personal curse, aren't you?

[SHADOW WEAVER kisses CASTASPELLA and the sparkling halo appears around her. To the right, KING MICAH covers his face with both hands, distraught]

KING MICAH. [Aside] Now, what's the spell to blind myself?

[ADORA and CATRA approach the throne]

ADORA. [Holding CATRA's hand] Mother, father. I understand the reasons you had for the decisions made years ago. But now, the damage has been repaired. So please, I beg of you: lift the ban on magic so our people and those of neighbouring kingdoms can once again feel free in Bright Moon. [Looks at CATRA] I wouldn't wish for the love of my life to feel threatened here… And I would like to feel free myself.

QUEEN ANGELLA. [Approaches] Oh, my dear… I understand [Sighs and looks away] And you're right. Banning magic was, perhaps, going too far. [Takes ADORA's free hand] It was unfair for you and Glimmer. I apologize.

ADORA. Just make it right now, mother. Lift the ban like Shadow Weaver lifted the curses.

QUEEN ANGELLA. So I shall.

[QUEEN ANGELLA embraces ADORA and CATRA, then goes for KING MICAH and they both walk to the center of the scene, approaching CASTASPELLA who is talking with GLIMMER; SHADOW WEAVER stands behind CASTASPELLA, silent. QUEEN ANGELLA and KING MICAH can be seen talking and laughing with GLIMMER and CASTASPELLA. The music resumes, ADORA and CATRA start dancing as the ball continues]

[Blackout]

[End Act 3]

Chapter End Notes

Tomorrow: Epilogue!
I hope u enjoyed until here, and see you tomorrow for the end!

Chapter 18

Chapter Summary

Characters:
ADORA, Prince of Bright Moon
BOW, ~~cursed~~ stable bow at the castle
CASTASPELLA, ~~cursed~~ sorceress
CATRA, heir to Half Moon
ELBERON BOY, ~~cursed~~ villager
ELBERON GIRL, ~~cursed~~ villager
GLIMMER, Princess of Bright Moon
GUARDS of Bright Moon palace
KING MICAH, King of Bright Moon
NETOSSA, chief of Bright Moon's docks
PERFUMA, Princess of Plumeria
QUEEN ANGELLA, Queen of Bright Moon
SCORPIA, ~~cursed~~ princess
SHADOW WEAVER, banished sorceress
SPINNERELLA, ~~cursed~~ chief of Bright Moon's docks
Other people

Epilogue

SCENE.—*Land of Etheria, two years later. Inside Bright Moon's palace, daytime. The main hall, where a wedding is about to take place. Music plays in the background. Large decorated windows at the back, several chandeliers hanging from the ceiling, and the throne to the right. Guards are standing at both sides of the gates to the left, where some tables have been set and people are mingling. In the center, multiple decorated benches are set for the guests to sit on when the wedding begins.*

CATRA. [Holding a cup] Come on, Adora. Chill a bit. Everyone is enjoying themselves. I just come from speaking with my moms, and they said they love the event. Also, I came across princess Perfuma and Scorpia, and they commented on it too. They are all having a good time!

ADORA. [Takes a deep breath] Right, right. I just… want this to be perfect.

CATRA. [Takes ADORA's hands] And it is! So calm down now. Let's go talk to your father, alright? [Leads her to the center, where KING MICAH and CASTASPELLA are sitting on the benches] Are we interrupting?

KING MICAH. Of course not. [To Adora] You didn't happen to see your sister, did you?

ADORA. [Pointing to the throne at the right] She's there with Bow, speaking with Mother.

KING MICAH. Oh, good then. [To CASTASPELLA] Do you mind if they join us then?

CASTASPELLA. Fine with me.

CATRA. [Takes a seat next to them with ADORA] What were you talking about?

KING MICAH. Once again, I am trying to convince her of returning to the palace now that she and all sorcerers are welcome back to the kingdom.

CASTASPELLA. And once again, I decline.

ADORA. Really? But why?

CASTASPELLA. Because I rather stay at the Woods with my fiancée, seeing how she's still banished. As I see it, we might as well regard her as my wife, despite not having married officially. That probably won't ever happen…

CATRA. I still remember what you said… [Nervous] When I accused you of betraying us, I mean… And it's a shame that you have to sacrifice so much just to remain with her.

CASTASPELLA. I already spent fourteen years there, and bearing a curse. What is another couple of years? [Laughs] Besides, I've been helping her make up for all her wrongdoings, for which we have travelled through different kingdoms, helping those she cursed, their families and towns, and even went all the way to Half Moon!

CATRA. Ah, yes. I remember. [To ADORA and KING MICAH] She told my moms everything that happened with the cursed and then apologized. It was… curious.

ADORA. Oh wait, I know! Glimmer told me Bow also got some help and became an apprentice like he wanted. So Shadow Weaver helped with that?

CASTASPELLA. [Nods] Indeed. It was my idea. [Giggles] That and helping with princess Perfuma's garden. Now *that* was interesting.

CATRA. I still can't believe she was stealing flowers. [Laughs]

KING MICAH. Flowers? But…

CASTASPELLA. If you're looking for a logical explanation, forget it. There's none. She's just like that… [Laughs lightly]

[The guests start filling the benches and interrupt them. CATRA offers ADORA her hand, and they walk up to the throne where QUEEN ANGELLA waits. CATRA and ADORA face each other and hold hands]

QUEEN ANGELLA. [Clears throat] Welcome, everyone, to this happy occasion. You have all been invited today to bear witness of this union between Adora, prince of Bright Moon, and Catra, heir of Half Moon. [Stays silent a moment, a round of applause] So it is with great pleasure that I begin this ceremony. [Waits until another round of applause ends] Prince Adora will now say a few words.

ADORA. [Nervous, looking at CATRA] I… I've been in love with you for… a very long time, and when you stopped coming to visit us, I felt… empty. I missed you all the time and, as you would say, never took a minute to stop and chill for a while. [Giggles] But it was the years apart that helped me see it wasn't a mere crush. So, when I saw you again, I simply knew it and couldn't let the opportunity pass again. And once more, Life put us to the test and I understood I needed to get to know you more, enough to recognize you even if some magic were affecting me. So in the past two years I… dedicated myself to that, and we can be sure I'd recognize you even if some evil magic tried to blind me again.

[ADORA laughs, the guests laugh too. QUEEN ANGELLA gestures at CATRA to speak]

CATRA. Now that we're on the subject… for me, the past two years were very special because, after being… transformed, everything looked different. The things I took for granted weren't there: from being able to speak with other people, to knowing whether I would wake up the next day, or if I would ever see my mothers again… [Glances briefly at her mothers, then looks back at ADORA] But I heard you that night… You never gave up on me despite knowing absolutely nothing about my whereabouts, my state, anything! You-you didn't care,

you just decided you'd go out to search for me as soon as you could! [Takes a step forward] And for that I know this is the right choice. I am marrying someone I can trust with my life.

QUEEN ANGELLA. [Waits until another round of applause ends] Now, the bows! Adora: Do you promise to love Catra, respect and protect her from all evil until the end of your times?

ADORA. I promise.

QUEEN ANGELLA. Catra: Do you promise to love Adora, respect and protect her from all evil until the end of your times?

CATRA. I promise.

QUEEN ANGELLA. Then it is my great honor to pronounce you spouses! You may now kiss!

[ADORA and CATRA kiss, the guests stand up and applaud. ADORA and CATRA walk to the center and are congratulated by the guests. KING MICAH approaches them and hugs ADORA tightly. Behind him, CASTASPELLA and GLIMMER wait]

ADORA. Dad, you're squeezing me…

KING MICAH. [Releases ADORA] Oh, I'm sorry. I'm just so happy!

GLIMMER. My turn now, dad! [Hugs ADORA and CATRA tightly] Finally!

CATRA. Yeah, yeah. I know… [Laughs] Now let me speak with your aunt, will you?

GLIMMER. Fine, fine. [Lets go of ADORA and CATRA] I'm really happy for you two!

[CASTASPELLA steps forward and embraces both ADORA and CATRA for a moment. QUEEN ANGELLA approaches them too]

CASTASPELLA. Congratulations, to the both of you! I couldn't possibly be happier! [Smiles brightly at them] Adora, I'm glad to see you grown into such a charming prince [Caresses ADORA's cheek briefly] And Catra, when we were cursed, I was so afraid to lose you too, that now I can't be more glad I get to see you recover your life and thrive!

CATRA. Oh, right. I was told many of the cursed had passed. What… happened with them?

CASTASPELLA. [Silent a moment, glances at KING MICAH and QUEEN ANGELLA] I… made a small graveyard in the woods for them, behind the Swan Lake of the hunting grounds.

ADORA. [Realizing] Oh, wait. I've seen that! The rocks always looked like graves to me, but I wasn't… sure.

CATRA. [Exchanges a glance with ADORA] We would… like to visit it, if it's not much trouble.

QUEEN ANGELLA. What!?

KING MICAH. [Places a hand on QUEEN ANGELLA's arm] And we… should too. [QUEEN ANGELLA stares at him] It's the irreparable damage of our inaction. We can't pretend it doesn't exist.

QUEEN ANGELLA. [Sighs] Alright. Yes. You're right. We should go…

CASTASPELLA. Just remember to be respectful, and you can go whenever you want.

ADORA. [Notices a shadow on the gates] Is that…?

[CASTASPELLA and CATRA turn to look at the gates. The shadow hides behind the wall]

CATRA. That must be her.

CASTASPELLA. [With a warning tone] Impossible. Because I made her promise she wouldn't ever return to the castle. [Stares at the gates and smirks as a raven can be seen flying away] But I believe it's time for me to leave now.

GLIMMER. [Sad] Auntie… [Embraces CASTASPELLA]

CATRA. Farewell, Sorceress.

[ADORA and CATRA embrace CASTASPELLA too and once they let go, KING MICAH and QUEEN ANGELLA farewell.

CASTASPELLA exits.

CATRA and ADORA approach the tables and are greeted by princess PERFUMA and SCORPIA; SPINNERELLA and NETOSSA soon join. Still near the benches, GLIMMER speaks with QUEEN ANGELLA and KING MICAH, and gestures for BOW and his fathers to approach. While they are talking, GLIMMER looks back at CATRA who is being surrounded by the ELBERON BOY and the ELBERON GIRL and laughs happily.]

[Curtain]

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